IA

Inventory Analyzer

READ-ONLY FOLDER AND FILE INVENTORY

INSTALLATION AND ADMINISTRATION GUIDE

Installation and Administration Guide

Installing, sharing, hosting, updating and supporting Inventory Analyzer

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Audience Administrators, IT support and the people who share the app with their team

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Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	First release: read-only folder scan, dashboard, inventory, storage analysis, optional duplicates, Excel and CSV exports, scan history
1.1	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	Folder Explorer, Where your files are, Show in folder tree, Folder Tree sheet
1.2	24-Oct-2026	Yasin Jariwala	Reopen saved scans and download their reports; seven numbered guides inside the app

Related documents

ID	Document
IA-UG-01	User Guide
IA-QS-03	Quick Start
IA-FAQ-04	FAQ and Troubleshooting
IA-TD-05	Technical Design
IA-UAT-06	UAT Test Cases
IA-RN-07	Release Notes v1.2

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1 About this guide

This guide explains how to install, share, host, update and support Inventory Analyzer. It is written for the person who sets the app up for themselves or a team: on Windows PCs, as a shared link, or on an internal web server.

For day-to-day use of the screens, see the User Guide (IA-UG-01). For the design and data model, see the Technical Design (IA-TD-05).

> **Before you scan important folders**
>
> Version 1.2 is tested automatically in Chromium with 98 tests, including scans of 26,000 files. The folder picker itself was tested with a stand-in, because automated tests cannot click a real system dialog. Before rolling the app out, complete the go-live checklist in section 10 on your own PCs, with your own folders.

1.1 What is in the repository

Part	Where it lives	Notes
Ready-to-run app	`Inventory Analyzer.html`	The whole application in one file, including the guides
Windows launcher	`Start Inventory Analyzer.bat`	Opens the HTML file in its own Microsoft Edge window
Source code	`src/`	React and TypeScript
Build scripts	`scripts/`, `vite.config.ts`, `package.json`	Build the single-file app and embed the guides
Documentation	`docs/`	These guides as Markdown, `docs/pdf/` as PDF, screenshots in `docs/images/`, builders in `docs/build/`
Product requirements	`docs/PRD and Master Prompt.docx`	The PRD v3.0 the app was built from
Tests	`tests/`	Unit, UI-scenario and end-to-end tests; `tests/SCENARIOS.md` lists the user scenarios
Test results	`test-reports/`	The latest test report
Sample exports	`sample-exports/`	An Excel workbook and CSVs produced from the test folder

The app has no server, no database, no account system and no installer. It is a web page that runs entirely in the browser. Everything it stores stays in that browser on that PC.

2 Requirements

2.1 For people using the app

Item	Requirement
Operating system	Windows 10 or 11 for the desktop launcher. Any desktop operating system with a supported browser for the HTML file or the shared link.
Browser	Microsoft Edge or Google Chrome (current version) for every feature. Firefox and Safari work with **Upload a folder** only.
Rights	No administrator rights. Read access to the folders being scanned.
Memory	4 GB minimum. The whole inventory is held in memory, so a few hundred thousand files is the practical limit on a typical laptop.
Disk	A few megabytes for the app. Scan history uses browser storage, which grows with the size of the saved scans; only the newest 20 scans keep full results.
Network	None. The app works offline. The shared link needs access to claude.ai to open.

2.2 Browser support

Browser	Choose folder (picker)	Upload a folder	Empty folders	Duplicate detection	Scan history
Microsoft Edge (Windows 10, 11)	Yes	Yes	Yes (picker)	Yes	Yes
Google Chrome (desktop)	Yes	Yes	Yes (picker)	Yes	Yes
Firefox	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Safari (macOS)	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Phone and tablet browsers	No	Varies	No	Varies	Yes

The New Scan screen checks the browser (**Browser capability check**) and greys out any option it cannot support.

2.3 For people building from source

Item	Requirement
Node.js	Version 18 or later (built and tested with Node 22)
npm	Comes with Node.js
Python	3.10 or later, only to rebuild the PDF guides
Git	To clone the repository

3 Installation

Choose one of four ways to run the app. All four run the same app and produce identical reports.

Option	Best for	Section
Windows desktop launcher	Everyday use on Windows PCs	3.1
The HTML file on any computer	macOS, Linux, or when .bat files are blocked	3.2
Shared link	Demos, colleagues outside your network, trying it out	3.3
Your own web server	A team-wide internal address	3.4

3.1 Windows desktop launcher

Setup takes about a minute and needs no administrator rights.

1. Get the two files: download the ZIP from https://github.com/yasin679/folder-file-inventory-analyzer (**Code > Download ZIP**), or use the shared package you were sent.
2. Copy these two files into one folder, for example `C:\Users\<you>\Tools\Inventory Analyzer\`:
   - `Start Inventory Analyzer.bat`
   - `Inventory Analyzer.html`
3. Double-click **Start Inventory Analyzer.bat**. The app opens in its own Microsoft Edge window.
4. Optional: right-click the .bat file, choose **Send to > Desktop (create shortcut)** and rename the shortcut "Inventory Analyzer".
5. First run: click **Try with sample data** and check the dashboard shows 318 files (User Guide, Appendix A). Then scan a real folder.

> **How the launcher works**
>
> The launcher runs `msedge --app="file:///…/Inventory Analyzer.html"`. If Edge is not found it opens the HTML file in the default browser. It installs nothing, changes no settings and needs no network. Keep the two files in the same folder.

If Windows shows **Windows protected your PC** the first time, click **More info > Run anyway**, or open the HTML file directly (section 3.2).

3.2 The HTML file on any computer

Open `Inventory Analyzer.html` in Edge or Chrome: double-click it if one of them is your default browser, or drag it into a browser window. Every feature works, including the folder picker and scan history.

In Firefox or Safari the app opens and scans with **Upload a folder**. Empty folders are not visible in that mode.

3.3 Shared link

The app is published as an artifact on claude.ai. The link is **private** until its owner shares it:

1. Open the Inventory Analyzer artifact on claude.ai while signed in as its owner.

2. Click **Share** and choose **Anyone with the link**.
3. Copy the link and send it.

Until step 2 is done, anyone else sees "Sign in to view this page". On the shared link:

- The browser asks you to confirm each download.
- The hosting page may block the folder picker. The app then says so and **Upload a folder...** works instead.
- Scan history is kept for that site in that browser, separate from the desktop launcher's history.
- The guides are built in (**Help & Documents**), so the one link carries everything.

3.4 Your own web server

`Inventory Analyzer.html` is a static file. It needs no server-side code.

1. Copy `Inventory Analyzer.html` to any static web host: IIS, nginx, Apache, an Azure Static Web App, GitHub Pages, or an internal file share published over HTTPS. Rename it `index.html` if you want it to open at the folder address.
2. Serve it over **HTTPS**. Browsers only allow the folder picker, duplicate fingerprinting and background scanning on secure pages (HTTPS or `localhost`).
3. Open the address in Edge or Chrome and run the sample-data check.

No configuration, database or environment variables are needed. The page makes no network requests after it loads.

3.5 Developer build

1. `git clone https://github.com/yasin679/folder-file-inventory-analyzer.git`
2. `cd folder-file-inventory-analyzer`
3. `npm install`
4. `npm run dev` and open http://localhost:5173

4 Configuration

There are no configuration files. Each person's settings live in their own browser.

Setting	Where	Default	Stored in
Include dot-prefixed items	New Scan or Settings	On	Browser local storage
Detect duplicate files (SHA-256)	New Scan or Settings	Off; switches itself off for each new session	Not stored
Large-file threshold	New Scan or Settings	100 MB	Browser local storage
Top-N report size	New Scan or Settings	25	Browser local storage
Hashing size limit (per file)	Settings	1,024 MB	Browser local storage
Keep full results of past scans on this PC	Settings	On	Browser local storage

Restore defaults in Settings resets the scan options. To change the defaults for everyone, change `DEFAULT_CONFIG` in `src/core/types.ts` and rebuild (section 7).

5 Data, privacy and security

5.1 What the app stores

Data	Where it lives	How long	How to remove it
The open scan (file and folder names, paths, sizes, dates)	Browser memory	Until the window closes	Close the window
Scan summaries	Browser IndexedDB on this PC	Until deleted, or until the browser clears site data	Scan History > **Delete** or **Clear all history**
Full results of the newest 20 scans (names, paths, sizes, dates; never contents)	Browser IndexedDB on this PC	Until deleted, pushed out by newer scans, or cleared by the browser	As above, or Settings > **Clear stored scan history**
Scan options	Browser local storage	Until changed or cleared	Settings > **Restore defaults**
Downloaded reports	Wherever the user saves them (default Downloads)	The user's choice	Delete the files

File contents are read only to compute fingerprints when duplicate detection is on, and are never stored.

5.2 Security controls

Control	How it is applied
Read-only access	The folder picker is opened with read permission only. The app contains no code that creates, writes, moves, renames or deletes files.
No network use	The app makes no network requests with scan data, and has no analytics or telemetry. An automated test fails if any request leaves the page during a scan or export.
Least exposure	Browsers expose only the chosen folder, paths relative to it, and the last-modified date. Full disk paths and other folders are never visible.
Formula-injection protection	CSV cells starting with `=`, `+`, `-` or `@` are prefixed with `'`. Excel cells are written as plain values, never formulas.
No secrets	There are no accounts, passwords, keys or tokens anywhere in the app.
Supply chain	Five runtime libraries (React, ExcelJS, fflate, Recharts, and marked for the guides), all bundled into the file at build time. Nothing is loaded from the internet at run time.

Reports contain folder and file names

The Excel and CSV reports list every file and folder name in the scanned folder. Treat them with the same care as the folder itself before sending them to anyone.

6 Distributing and updating

Task	How
Share with colleagues	Send the two files (zipped), put them on a shared drive, or send the shared link. Some mail filters block .bat files: then send only the HTML file.
Update to a new version	Replace `Inventory Analyzer.html` with the new one. The launcher does not change. Scan history and settings are kept.
Update the shared link	Republish the artifact; the link stays the same.
Check the version	Settings > **About** shows it. The current release is **v1.2**.
Remove the app	Delete the two files. To remove stored history too, first use Settings > **Clear stored scan history**, or clear the browser's site data.

7 Building from source

Task	Command	Output
Install dependencies	`npm install`	`node_modules/`
Run for development	`npm run dev`	http://localhost:5173
Production build (several files)	`npm run build`	`dist/`
Single-file build	`npm run build:single`	`dist-single/index.html`; copy it over `Inventory Analyzer.html`
Embed the guides only	`npm run docs:embed`	`src/generated/docs.ts`
Regenerate sample exports	`npm run samples`	`sample-exports/`

Both builds run `docs:embed` first, which bundles the Markdown guides, their screenshots and the PDFs into the app for **Help & Documents**.

7.1 Rebuilding the guides

The Markdown files in `docs/` are the source. The PDFs and screenshots are generated:

```
pip install markdown pypdf playwright
playwright install chromium
python docs/build/build_pdfs.py                  # all guides -> docs/pdf/
python docs/build/build_pdfs.py user-guide       # one guide
```

To refresh the screenshots, start the app with `npx vite build && npx vite preview --port 4173`, then run `node docs/build/capture_screenshots.mjs` in a second terminal. Then rebuild the PDFs and the app.

8 Verifying a build

Run the automated tests before distributing a new build. Version 1.2 passes all 98.

Suite	Command	Tests	What it proves
Unit	`npm run test:unit`	42	Counts, direct and recursive sizes, duplicates, errors, cancellation, folder tree, history storage, Excel and CSV correctness
UI scenarios	`npm run test:ui`	47	Every user scenario driven through the real app with clicks and typing
End-to-end	`npm run test:e2e`	9	The production build in Chromium: real folder scan, downloads reopened, no network, phone layout, keyboard use, large scan reopened after reload
Everything with coverage	`npm run test:all`	98	Writes coverage to `test-reports/coverage`

Before the first end-to-end run, install the test browser once: `npx playwright install chromium`. The scenarios are listed in `tests/SCENARIOS.md`; the UAT cases for people are in IA-UAT-06.

9 Backup and retention

The app keeps no data of its own outside the browser, so there is nothing to back up on a server.

- **Reports are the record.** Download the Excel workbook for any scan you must keep, and store it with your other records.
- **Scan history is a convenience, not an archive.** Browsers can remove it at any time (private windows, clearing browsing data, low disk space). Only the newest 20 scans keep full results.
- **Moving to another PC** does not move history. Scan again on the new PC, or keep the reports.

10 Go-live checklist

#	Check	Done
1	The app opens on a standard user PC with the launcher (or your chosen option)	
2	**Try with sample data** gives 318 files, 27 folders, 1.03 GB (IA-UG-01, Appendix A)	
3	**Choose folder...** works on a real folder; the folder's file count matches Windows Explorer's Properties	
4	**Upload a folder...** works in the browsers your team uses	
5	Excel and CSV downloads open in your version of Excel	
6	A scan reopens from Scan History after closing and reopening the app	
7	The mandatory UAT cases in IA-UAT-06 pass	
8	People know where the guides are (**Help & Documents**) and who to ask for help	
9	If you use the shared link: it is set to **Anyone with the link** and opens in a private window	

11 Getting help

For error messages and common questions, see the FAQ and Troubleshooting guide (IA-FAQ-04). Bugs and requests can be raised as issues on the GitHub repository: https://github.com/yasin679/folder-file-inventory-analyzer.